

CLASS X — PRE-BOARD EXAMINATION 2026

ENGLISH LANGUAGE & LITERATURE (184) — PAPER 1

Date: 12 October 2026 | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 80

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. This question paper contains 11 questions divided into Sections A, B and C.
2. Section A — Reading Skills: 20 marks; Section B — Grammar & Writing: 20 marks; Section C — Literature: 40 marks.

SECTION A — READING SKILLS (20 MARKS)

Q1. Discursive Passage (10 Marks): Passage on digital information, attention span, sustained concentration in deep learning, and role of technology in education.

Questions: (a) Why access to info does not produce understanding (b) Meaning of 'attention as valuable resource' (c) Productive learning sign (d) Role of tech without replacing judgment (e) Central idea MCQ (f) Vocabulary & inference questions.

Q2. Case-based Passage (10 Marks): Data analysis on voluntary school reading programme (Month 1: 120, Month 2: 156, Month 3: 180 students).

Questions: Percentage increase calculation, student autonomy, flexible reading targets, conclusions and strategies.

SECTION B — GRAMMAR & CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS (20 MARKS)

Q3. Grammar Tasks (10 Marks): Modals, Determiners, Subject-Verb Agreement, Error Correction ('Each of the participants have...'), Reported Speech, Correct Tenses.

Q4. Formal Letter (5 Marks): Letter to Editor expressing concern over excessive short-form digital video distraction among students.

Q5. Analytical Paragraph (5 Marks): Compare 200 students' revision preferences (Self-study: 70, Group: 40, Online: 55, Classes: 35).

SECTION C — LITERATURE (40 MARKS)

Q6. Extract based on 'A Letter to God' (5 Marks): Lencho's faith, hailstorm turning point, irony in receiving money.

Q7. Extract based on 'The Ball Poem' (5 Marks): Ball symbolism, loss experience, epistemology of loss.

Q8. Short Answer Questions (5 x 2 = 10 Marks): Nelson Mandela freedom concept, Anne Frank diary, Valli's bus journey, Mijbil the Otter, Fire and Ice, The Trees, The Proposal ending.

Q9. Supplementary Short Answer (3 x 2 = 6 Marks): Thief's Story, Midnight Visitor Ausable, Bholi's transformation, Griffin's invisibility.

Q10 & Q11. Long Answer Questions (2 x 5 = 10 Marks): Compare courage in Mandela vs Bholi OR Humour in The Proposal vs Book That Saved Earth; Trust as force in Thief's Story vs Appearance aspirations in The Necklace.